Experience - 142

Google

Software Engineer | Level : L3

Interview Experience



Summary

📌 **Job Role**: Software Development Engineer
🔢 **Number of Rounds**: 5
📜 **Offer Status**: Rejected
📍 **Location**: Bangalore
👤 **Candidate Name**: Not disclosing due to signed NDA

Interview Process:

- I applied on the Google Careers portal with a referral. A recruiter reached out to me within a couple of days. Since I was not interview-ready at that point, I asked for 6 weeks of preparation time, which the recruiter agreed to.
- Interestingly, the phone screen round was skipped. I was directly scheduled for the coding interviews. After completing all the technical rounds, the recruiter informed me that the rounds went positively and proceeded with the Team Match process.
- During Team Match, I had multiple calls with various teams to assess fitment. I selected the team I felt the most aligned with. Following this, my packet was sent to the Hiring Committee and it got approved.

Preparation Guide

- Here’s what I used during my preparation journey:
- Leetcode discussion forums were incredibly helpful and a gold mine of information.
- I regularly followed Tushar Roy’s YouTube channel, which helped me build fundamentals and approaches for standard problems.
- Errichto’s YouTube channel had valuable content for certain tricky problems.
- The MIT 6.006 Courseware on YouTube was a strong resource to build up algorithmic thinking.
- During my college years, I had solved a good number of problems on HackerRank, SPOJ, CodeChef, and Codeforces. That foundation helped a lot.
- Subscribed to LeetCode Premium for a month, which gave me access to Google-tagged questions and company-specific frequency analysis.
- I solved Google-tagged problems in increasing order of frequency. This ensured I was not just doing hard problems, but also repeated patterns.
- I gave special focus to Graph and Dynamic Programming (DP) problems, again working in increasing order of frequency.

Round 1: Coding

- **Duration**: ~60 minutes
- **Difficulty Level**: Medium

- **Experience:**
- This round was focused on a string-based problem that involved encryption and decryption under specific constraints. After solving the initial version, I was asked to work through a follow-up problem that added more complexity and required a slightly different approach.
- The problem leaned heavily on implementation skills and general problem-solving ability. Though it didn’t involve heavy algorithms, attention to detail and clarity in coding were key.

- **Key Learnings:**
- Focus on clear and structured problem-solving.
- Clean implementation matters, especially under constraints

Round 2 : Coding

- **Duration**: ~60 minutes
- **Difficulty Level**: Medium

- **Experience:**
- This was a geometry-centric problem involving 2-D points. After the initial solution, the problem was extended into a dynamic setup where points could be added or removed — similar to processing a stream.
- This required solid understanding of slopes, BSTs, and coordinate geometry fundamentals. My experience with coordinate-based problems and some competitive programming exposure came in handy here.

- **Key Learnings:**
- Brush up on BSTs and how they can be used with geometry.
- Understanding of slope calculations and dynamic data handling is essential.

Round 3 : Coding

- **Duration**: ~60 minutes
- **Difficulty Level**: Medium

- **Experience:**
- This was one of the most engaging rounds. The initial problem was array and permutation-based with some constraints. Once solved, a follow-up removed the constraints, making the logic more straightforward but still needing optimization.
- Since I completed both relatively quickly, the interviewer threw in an additional string problem. I managed to implement that too. This round felt like a rewarding discussion more than a strict Q&A session.

- **Key Learnings:**
- Prepare for the possibility of solving more than one problem in a round.
- Quick problem comprehension and adaptability make a difference.
- Build speed without compromising correctness.

Round 4 : Coding

- **Duration**: ~60 minutes
- **Difficulty Level:** Medium

- **Experience:**
- This round also focused on geometry, involving the 2-D plane. The follow-up involved implementing a solution in a language-specific way, particularly focusing on data structures like hash maps and custom hash functions.
- The round was slightly more implementation-heavy than algorithmic. Having a grasp of basic geometry and understanding how to work with language internals helped a lot here.

- **Key Learnings:**
- Know your programming language's capabilities and limitations, especially regarding hashing.
- Custom hash functions can sometimes be the key to efficient solutions.
- Geometry continues to be a recurring topic — make sure your basics are strong.

Round 5 : Googleyness Round

- **Duration**: ~45 minutes
- **Difficulty Level:** Easy

- **Experience:**
- This was a behavioral round focused on assessing team fit and general approach toward work and problem-solving. The interviewer was friendly and conversational.
- I was asked about my past projects, leadership experiences, and times when I had challenged existing systems or processes. Overall, it felt more like a mutual discussion than a one-sided evaluation.

- **Key Learnings:**
- Prepare to articulate your experiences and decisions clearly.
- Highlight moments when you made impactful contributions or questioned the status quo.
- Behavioral rounds are equally important — don’t take them lightly.

Final Thoughts:

- Here are some takeaways from my Google interview experience:
- Consistency matters. Don’t just grind problems randomly. Follow a structured plan — like increasing order of frequency for company-tagged problems.
- Deepen your fundamentals. Most questions, even if framed uniquely, rely on foundational concepts — arrays, strings, geometry, graphs, or DP.
- Practice coding under time pressure. Being able to write correct, clean code quickly helped me in multiple rounds.
- Mock interviews help, even if just self-timed. They simulate the environment and reduce anxiety.
- Communication is key. Verbalizing your approach helps the interviewer understand your thought process.
- Good luck to anyone preparing — stay focused and believe in your prep!

Experience Link

Thank You

Roundz.ai

Follow us

roundz-ai

roundz-ai